Making Tax Digital for Income Tax: your 2026 to 2027 quarterly deadlines

If you use MTD for Income Tax, you normally send four quarterly updates a year using your software. Each update is cumulative, covering the tax year so far. The table below shows the coverage for standard update periods.

Update	Cumulative coverage — standard update periods	Send by	Done
1st	6 April to 5 July 2026	**7 August 2026**	☐
2nd	6 April to 5 October 2026	**7 November 2026**	☐
3rd	6 April 2026 to 5 January 2027	**7 February 2027**	☐
4th	6 April 2026 to 5 April 2027	**7 May 2027**	☐
Tax return	2026 to 2027 tax year	**31 January 2028**	☐

- Using calendar update periods for an accounting period of 1 April to 31 March? The update periods end on 30 June, 30 September, 31 December and 31 March; the send-by dates are unchanged. Select calendar update periods in your software before sending your first quarterly update, and follow HMRC's guidance on the figures to include.
- No income or expenses in a period? You still need to send the update.
- Late updates: HMRC says there are no penalty points for late quarterly updates in the 2026 to 2027 tax year, but you must send them all before you can submit your tax return.

Sources (GOV.UK):

- Quarterly updates, periods and deadlines: https://www.gov.uk/guidance/use-making-tax-digital-for-income-tax/send-quarterly-updates
- Penalties: https://www.gov.uk/guidance/penalties-for-making-tax-digital-for-income-tax
- Tax return deadline (31 January after the tax year ends): https://www.gov.uk/guidance/use-making-tax-digital-for-income-tax/submit-your-tax-return

Get a reminder the week before each deadline: mtdfinder.co.uk/newsletter

General information, not tax advice. Check GOV.UK or ask an accountant about your own situation.

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